

Decode the Product

Mentors:

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Structure Overview:

This project is structured across **three weeks**. In the **first week**, we'll introduce mentees to the **basics of Product Management** and key frameworks like MECE, Fishbone Diagrams, 5 WHYS, PESTEL, SWOT, and the 4 Ps, helping them build a clear, structured approach to problem-solving and analysis. The **second week** will focus on **Product Thinking, metrics, and the use of AI tools in PM**, where we'll cover frameworks like CIRCLES, AARRR, and DAU/MAU, along with how AI can assist in research, ideation, and product analysis. In the **final week**, we'll work through two **Root Cause Analysis (RCA) case studies** — one that we'll solve together, mentors with mentees to demonstrate the process, and another that mentees will take on as a deliverable, applying everything they've learned throughout the program. (On the basis of which they'll also be evaluated)

Week-wise Breakdown:

Day / Session	Lecture Title	Concepts & Contents of Lecture	Learning Outcomes
Week 1 Session 1	Introduction to Product Management & MECE Thinking	- Role of a PM across discovery → delivery → growth - PM skillset & cross-functional nature - MECE Framework : breaking complex problems into mutually exclusive and collectively exhaustive components - Caselet Example: <i>Decline in user engagement for a Zomato, how to break it down via MECE</i>	- Understand what Product Management entails - Learn to structure problems logically and exhaustively using MECE - Develop clarity in problem definition

Week 1 Session 2	Root Cause Analysis: 5 WHYS & Fishbone Diagrams	- 5 WHYS framework — tracing root causes step-by-step - Fishbone Diagram (Ishikawa) mapping causes under categories: People, Process, Product, Technology - Example: <i>Why did activation rate drop post feature launch?</i> - Hands-on Fishbone creation exercise	- Learn to identify true root causes vs symptoms - Apply visual RCA methods to product problems - Build structured analytical thinking
Week 1 Session 3	Business Environment Frameworks: PESTEL, SWOT & 4Ps	- PESTEL Analysis: Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Environmental, Legal factors - SWOT Analysis: Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats - 4 Ps of Marketing: Product, Price, Place, Promotion - Activity: Apply all three to a real product (e.g. Zepto, Zomato, or Notion)	- Understand external and internal factors affecting a product - Learn to evaluate competitive positioning and strategy - Build market context awareness
Week 2 Session 4	Product Thinking & the CIRCLES Method	- Concept of Product Thinking: problem-first mindset - CIRCLES Method: Comprehend situation, Identify user, Report needs, Cut scope, List solutions, Evaluate trade-offs, Summarize recommendation - Exercise: Design a user onboarding feature using CIRCLES	- Learn a structured approach to product ideation - Frame user-centric problems and solutions - Apply the CIRCLES framework to real feature design
Week 2 Session 5	Growth Metrics & the AARRR Framework	- Introduction to product metrics and measurement philosophy - AARRR Framework: Acquisition, Activation, Retention, Revenue, Referral - Core metrics: DAU/MAU, Retention, Churn, Conversion - Mini exercise: Identify key metrics for a social app feature	- Understand product growth levers and funnel metrics - Learn to link business goals with data metrics - Ability to define KPIs for features or products

Week 2 Session 6	AI Tools for PMs	- Overview: how AI supports PM workflows (research, ideation, PRD drafting, competitor analysis) - Tools: We'll choose important ones out of these afterwards. D-ID - digital human creation... AI TOOLS FOR POSTS	- Gain exposure to AI-assisted PM workflows - Learn how to integrate frameworks into real scenarios - Build comfort with using AI for structured thinking
Week 3 Session 7	RCA Case Study (Mentor-Led)	Live case study walkthrough: Frameworks applied, Step-by-step reasoning demonstration - Discussion on insights and presentation format	- Learn how to conduct end-to-end RCA - Understand framework integration in case solving - Gain clarity on analytical storytelling
Week 3 Session 8	RCA Deliverable Case (Mentee-Led)	- Case assignment for mentees. Deliverable: 5-slide RCA using minimum 3 frameworks - Mentor feedback & short team presentations	- Apply all learned frameworks independently - Strengthen RCA problem-solving and communication skills - Gain feedback for improvement in structured analysis

The two Case Studies to be done in the last week haven't been decided by now. We planned to make the case studies more personalized to this project by observing the sessions' flow and interests and doubts of the mentees and thus designing the case studies which are thoroughly consistent with the project and are innovative and interesting to solve.